

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: “A RESOLUTION ADOPTING THE WEST EDGE VISIONARY BLUEPRINT AS A WORKING DOCUMENT AND GUIDE TO THE COMMUNITY’S GOALS OF MANAGING STORMWATER IN THE LOWER CAPITOL BASIN, MITIGATING BROWNFIELDS, CREATING MEANINGFUL PUBLIC SPACES, AND FACILITATING PRIVATE INVESTMENT IN THE NEAR WEST SIDE OF DOWNTOWN CHEYENNE.”

WHEREAS, the impacts from a storm event centered over the Lower Capitol Basin could cost the Cheyenne community more than \$70 million directly, and over \$100 million including indirect costs; and

WHEREAS, the voters of Laramie County have approved \$4.8 million in 6th Penny Optional Sales Tax funds to begin addressing stormwater management in the Lower Capitol Basin; and

WHEREAS, it is desirable to leverage local tax dollars with other, non-local funds to extend the impact and efficacy of local funding; and

WHEREAS, the West Edge Visionary Blueprint is the embodiment of citizen input received at three open house meetings, the comments and discussion of 200 registered website users, and 1200 unique visitors to the online Mindmixer web platform, along with commentary received during a public comment period; and

WHEREAS, the West Edge project has been guided by representatives from the City of Cheyenne, Laramie County, and the Downtown Development Authority/Mainstreet Board; and

WHEREAS, the West Edge Visionary Blueprint acknowledges the need to maintain a flexible approach to siting stormwater improvements to maximize opportunities for efficient property acquisition costs; and

WHEREAS, the flexible approach enables implementation of incremental and segmented solutions tailored to match potential funding sources; and

WHEREAS, stormwater infrastructure can serve a dual purpose as civic open space, with the potential to function as a neighborhood amenity capable of attracting reinvestment; and

WHEREAS, a variety of stormwater feature concepts are illustrated in the West Edge Visionary Blueprint that can be used to create an interconnected system of detention and water quality features; and

WHEREAS, redevelopment concepts supported by potential civic amenities have been illustrated to demonstrate the potential of the West Edge District; and

WHEREAS, the City and Coalition Partners have received a \$1 million U.S. Environmental Protection Agency Assessment Grant to fund planning and environmental assessments in an effort to encourage redevelopment and investment; and

WHEREAS, a portion of the Assessment Grant funding has been utilized to conduct environmental assessments on 24 parcels to aid property owners in characterizing the presence of any contaminants and to streamline future real estate transactions; and

WHEREAS, the City of Cheyenne has been awarded a \$1.2 million U.S. Environmental Protection Agency Cleanup Revolving Loan Fund to assist property owners in mitigating environmental issues; and

WHEREAS, the West Edge Visionary Blueprint also contains potential tools for consideration which may enable further advancement of the primary project components, many of which will require further research and consideration.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING:

That the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne hereby adopts the West Edge Visionary Blueprint as the working document and guide to the community's goals of managing stormwater in the Lower Capitol Basin, mitigating brownfields, creating meaningful public spaces, and facilitating private investment in the near west side of Downtown Cheyenne.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne recommends that the West Edge Visionary Blueprint be used to guide and shape the improvement and revitalization of the West Edge and Lower Capitol Basin areas.

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED THIS __ DAY OF _____, 2014.

Richard L. Kaysen, Mayor
City of Cheyenne

(Seal)

ATTEST:

Carol Intlekofer, City Clerk